

Justification & Approval For Other than Full and Open Competition

As a legislative branch agency, the Library is subject to the competition and advertising requirements of 41 U.S.C. § 6101. Like the Competition in Contracting Act and the FAR, 41 U.S.C. § 6101 does not require competition when a contracting officer certifies that only one source or brand-name item is available, when dictated by public exigency, or when otherwise authorized by law.

This document sets forth the justification and approval for award of a contract or order by means providing for other than full and open competition per 41 U.S.C. § 6101, LCR 7-210, and, as applicable, FAR 6.302, FAR 13.106-1, FAR 8.405, and FAR 16.505. Contracting without competition shall not be justified on the basis of a lack of advance planning or concerns related to availability of funds.

This form shall be used to support instances where competition will be limited to a single source, a limited number of sources, including where a brand name product is required.

Part 1 – Identification

1. Contracting Agency and Activity: Library of Congress, Library Services, Preservation Directorate, Preservation Research and Testing Division

2. Nature of Action Being Approved

- ☒ Contract (or modification)
- ☐ LoC or Leg Branch Order (or modification)
- ☐ GSA Schedule or GWAC:
- ☐ Other:

Requisition Number: 2025-LGD-0066
Contractor (or Brand Name): Parameter Generation and Control, Inc.
Estimated Value (Base and all options): [REDACTED]
Period of Performance: 06/13/25 to 06/12/26
Option Year I: 06/13/26 to 06/12/27
Option Year II: 06/13/27 to 06/12/28
Option Year II 06/13/28 to 06/12/29

3. Description of Supplies or Services Required to Meet Library Needs

Describe the supplies or services that are required to meet the Library's minimum needs and the delivery schedule required to meet those needs. Do not focus on a description of the program.

The Library requires the following supplies or services: The Preservation Research and Testing Division (PRTD) requires a preventative maintenance and comprehensive service agreement for Parameter Generation and Control (PGC) environmental control chambers (serial numbers: 0809031, 0809032, 1362-03, 1362-04, 1705-04, and 1806222). The service support agreement must include two preventative maintenance visits per year for walk-in chambers (with provision of annually calibrated temperature and humidity sensors on each units and all necessary service parts), a repair and service plan for four reach-in environmental chambers, and full software/firmware support and updates for continued operation. This instrumentation is planned for near constant usage for research and routine testing of a broad range of Library collection materials under precisely controlled environmental conditions.

Part 2 – Program Office Justification & Approval

4. Authority for Contracting Without Competition

Over \$250,000

For this requirement over \$250,000, under FAR part 6, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☐ There is only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy Library requirements. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(C); FAR 6.302-1.
 - ☐ Library's minimum needs can only be satisfied by contractor's unique capabilities or products. FAR 6.302-1(b)(1).
 - ☐ Source controls copyrights, patents, raw materials, or secret processes cannot be acquired otherwise, or similar circumstances. FAR 6.302-1(b)(2).
 - ☐ Other exception identified in FAR 6.302-1: Identify the exception
- ☐ There is such unusual & compelling urgency that the Government would be seriously injured if competition is not limited. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(B); FAR 6.302-2. Option years are not permitted.
- ☐ Source is expressly authorized or required by statute (e.g., AbilityOne, UNICOR, GPO, GSA Public Buildings Service, Appropriations Act, etc.) per 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 6.302-5: Identify the authority
- ☐ Other basis authorized in 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b) or FAR part 6.302: Identify the exception
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product or item which is essential to the Government's requirement. FAR 6.302-1(c).
- ☐ The Product is listed on the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

Up to and including \$250,000

For this requirement up to \$250,000, using simplified acquisition procedures under FAR part 13, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☒ Only one responsible source is reasonably available to meet Library requirements. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b); FAR 13.106-1.
 - ☒ Product or service is reasonably available from only one source.
 - ☐ Source controls copyrights, patents or other exclusive licensing arrangements.
 - ☐ Urgent circumstances; only one source can reasonably deliver by required date. Option years are not permitted.
 - ☐ Source is expressly authorized or required by statute: Identify the authority
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product
- ☐ The Product is listed the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

GSA Schedule Order

For this GSA schedule order under FAR part 8, the basis for not competing among GSA schedule-holders and/or specifying a brand name product or item is:

- ☐ An urgent and compelling need exists, and following GSA procedures would result in unacceptable delays. FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(A).
- ☐ Only one GSA source is capable of fulfilling the requirement at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized. FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B).
- ☐ In the interest of economy and efficiency, the new work is a logical follow-on to an original order that was placed competitively among GSA schedule-holders (i.e., the original order was not sole-source or limited-source.) FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(C).
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product
- ☐ The Product is listed on the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

Order Under Multiple Award Indefinite-Delivery Contract or GWAC

For this order under FAR subpart 16.5, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☐ The need is so urgent fair opportunity would result in unacceptable delays. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(C) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(A).
- ☐ The Library's minimum needs can only be satisfied by contractor's unique capabilities or products. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B).
- ☐ A logical follow-on order in the interest of economy and efficiency. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(C).
- ☐ To satisfy a minimum guarantee. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(D).
- ☐ Authorized or required by statute. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(E).
- ☐ The Library's minimum needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product or item which is essential to the Government's requirement. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(B) and FAR 16.505(a)(4)(i).
- ☐ The Product is listed on the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

5. Rationale for Contracting Without Competition

In supporting an action not providing for full and open competition, it is not sufficient to demonstrate that the contractor is exceptionally well qualified or even the best qualified, or that the required brand name product is well suited to the Library's needs. The rationale must demonstrate that no one else, or no other competing product, can satisfactorily fulfill the Library's requirement. Do not focus on the importance of the requirement; the issue is the rationale for not competing.

In supporting urgency, address the following: What are the unexpected facts or the unpredictable events that led to this situation? When is the required delivery or performance start date? Why this date? What specific harm to the Government will occur if the delivery is not made or performance not begun as scheduled? (Note that expiration of funds is not sufficient harm to justify not competing.) Demonstrate that the contract is only for items and quantities urgently needed until a competitive procurement action can be developed, or that a separate competitive follow-on is not practical.

In supporting a brand name justification, the brand name or feature must be essential to the Library's requirements, and market research indicates that other company's similar products or products with similar features cannot meet or be modified to meet the Library's needs.

We are authorized to limit competition on the basis of the citation in section 4 because: The PGC environmental chambers used in PRTD are either custom-manufactured chambers (in the case of PRTD's walk-in chambers) or equipment manufactured with specialized parts from the manufacturer.

In market research conducted in 2024, the Library identified one non-manufacturer business that had the capability to provide some of the services of this requirement. However, that business indicated that they would be unable to purchase necessary replacement parts which is a critical aspect of the chamber support and maintenance (email exchange between Richard Block, ESPEC representative and A. Davis, LC COR dated 2 Oct. 2024). This is likely because PGC has indicated a dwindling supply of spare parts due to a planned slowing of support agreements in the near future. PGC's intention is to hold remaining spare parts for existing customers ONLY, of which the Library is one, thereby restricting possible third-party vendors from providing OEM materials.

Therefore, due to the proprietary nature of the parts, support, and software, Parameter Generation and Control, Inc. is the only source that can provide the service required and guarantee the parts needed for routine servicing. The use of unauthorized service, software, or parts could be detrimental to the function of the chambers and negate future support efforts or agreements with PGC and the Library is authorized to limit competition in accordance with FAR 6.302-1.

6. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition Before Subsequent Contract Is Required

State what actions, if any, the program office can take to overcome barriers to competition before a contracting for this requirement again, such as: using action to provide time to develop specifications for a competitive procurement by a certain date; licensing copyrights or patents so other contractors may use the works; or breaking the requirement into parts that may be purchased competitively. If this is a one-time requirement, explain that action to increase future competition is not needed. If the source is expressly required by statute, state "Source is statutory."

To increase competition, we will: The Library performs ongoing research, including speaking with the manufacturer and companies that service similar equipment, to ensure it has current knowledge of the field. The Library verified that, at this time, this requirement can only be fulfilled by Parameter Generation and Control, Inc. The Library will continue communication with the manufacturer and vendors in the field to stay abreast of changes that may allow authorized third-party service vendors or part suppliers. The capabilities of known vendors will also be regularly monitored to see if they change their offerings.

7. Program Office Certification

I certify that the description of the Government's minimum needs, schedule requirements, and technical information that provide the basis for this justification are accurate and complete.

			 /2025
_____ Name	_____ Title	_____ Signature	_____ Date

Part 3 – Contracting Officer Determinations & Certification

8. Efforts to Solicit from As Many Potential Sources As Practicable

Unless a justification is based on FAR 6.302-2, Unusual and compelling urgency, contracting officers shall post justifications for other than full and open competition, including brand name justifications, to the Contract Opportunities website on beta.sam.gov (or eBuy for Brand Name Justifications under FAR Part 8) prior to requesting a proposal or otherwise entering into negotiations.

- ☒ Advance notice will be published in beta.sam.gov for 15 days before a contract is awarded. FAR 5.203(a).
- ☐ Advance or concurrent notice will be published in beta.sam.gov for a reasonable time for commercial items FAR 5.203(a) and 12.204(b).
- ☐ Advance notice will not be published because the action meets the following FAR exception:
- ☐ Notice would compromise national security. FAR 5.202(a)(1).
 - ☐ Unusual and compelling urgency; notice period would seriously injure Government. FAR 5.202(a)(2).
 - ☐ Expressly authorized or required to be made through another Government agency. FAR 5.202(a)(4).
 - ☐ Order will be placed against an IDIQ contract awarded under FAR 16.5. FAR 5.202(a)(6).
 - ☐ Order will be placed against GSA schedule or other competitively-awarded contract. FAR 5.202(a)(11).
 - ☐ Other:
- ☐ Advance notice will not be published per 41 U.S.C. § 6101; see attached deviation from the FAR per LCR 7-210 § 3.A.

We made the following efforts to interest potential sources in this award: Not applicable.

9. Listing of Sources That Expressed Interest in Writing

The following sources expressed interest in this award: Vendor ESPEC North America, which provides similar equipment, can fulfill part of this requirement but not all of it. Apart from this company, no other sources expressed interest or capabilities.

10. Additional Information

The following additional information is relevant to this justification and approval: Not applicable.

11. Contracting Officer Determination that Price Is Fair and Reasonable

As explained in detail below, I have determined that the prices for this contracting action are fair and reasonable based on comparison of the prices to the following (see FAR 15.404-1(b)(2)):

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Historical prices paid by the Government | ☐ Published competitive price lists |
| ☒ Library's Independent Government Estimate | ☒ Prices obtained through market research |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Prices obtained through competitive proposals |

The following analysis (based on attached pricing information) supports my determination: Pricing shall be determined to be fair and reasonable before a contract is awarded.

12. Contracting Officer Determination of Responsibility

- ☒ Checked System for Award Management (or will check in the case of competitive proposals for a brand name product)

13. Contracting Officer Determination of Best Value

I have determined that this action represents the best value to the Government because: Parameter Generation and Control, Inc. is the only vendor that offers the services and parts that can fulfill the Library's requirement, and their prices will be evaluated for fairness and reasonableness before award.

14. Contracting Officer Certification

I certify that, to the best of my knowledge and belief, this justification is accurate and complete. For those actions up to \$700,000, I approve contracting without competition for this requirement.

Jennifer Zwahlen

Name

Jennifer Zwahlen

Signature

03/14/2025

Date